During the first decade of the Revolution, Fagen examined three processes that he saw as key to the Revolution's attempt to create a new political culture: the literacy campaign; the Committees for the Defense of the Revolution (CDRs); and the Schools of Revolutionary Instruction (EIRs). The literacy campaign was a year-long process in 1961; the EIRs functioned from 1960 to 1967; and the CDRs, also created in 1960, continue to function to this day. In all three examples, the revolutionary leadership designed projects specifically aimed at creating the "new man" through mobilization and participation.

These programs were part and parcel of the dramatic structural changes of the early years of the Revolution. Mobilization and education were integral to creating a more equal society, to economic development, and to defense against foreign aggression and domestic subversion. "In the Cuban view," Fagen concludes, "the developmental problems faced by the poorer nations cannot be solved by the conventional application of conventional technology. In fact, national development is not in the first instance a technical or even an economic problem. It is a political problem: its causes are political and its solutions must be political."[5]

Cultural transformation also had a strong *rural* component. Just as the guerrillas in the sierra had developed their revolutionary ideology through their intimate contact with the realities of rural life, so must urban Cubans as a whole raise their consciousness of their country's social and political reality by coming to know the rural areas. Urban Cubans went to the countryside to transform rural culture by teaching peasants to read, but also to transform themselves. It was to be a revolutionary education for both parties.

During the 1970s, the period of institutionalization and a return to material incentives, there was also a certain retreat from the utopian goals of cultural transformation. The re-introduction of material incentives, and the return to legalizing small businesses and even, after 1980, farmers markets, symbolized a scaling down of the ambition of entirely remaking Cuban society and its members.

But if the ideology of the "new man" became less salient, the growth of cultural activity did not. "In 1959, Cuba published less than one